Majid] oversaw the other. Sajid's personal history is murky. According to Headley, Sajid joined Lashkar in roughly 1994 when he was eighteen years old. After heading the Lahore unit, he graduated to a position in the External Affairs department where he became responsible for handling overseas operatives. In this capacity, he allegedly visited numerous countries on 'business trips' including Canada, Dubai, India, Qatar, Syria and Thailand. Numerous references to Sajid Mir suggest he is a former army officer. Headley made no reference to this in his testimony when detailing Sajid's rise in the organization, though it is possible he served in the army at some stage. Also unclear is the degree of coordination between the two units or when each was launched. Notably, Syed finally split from Lashkar in 2008, but kept control over his unit in Karachi. Two things are clear from Headley's testimony. First, the purpose of each unit in Karachi was to launch operations in India using indigenous actors. Second, Lashkar members were in contact with and received assistance from ISI officers for these operations.[111]

In addition to supporting and promoting attacks by indigenous militants, Lashkar continued to launch its own fidayeen assaults. In September 2002, approximately six months after the Gujarat riots, two Lashkar fidayeen stormed the Akshardham Temple in Gandhinagar, the Gujarat state capital.[112] Approximately 600 worshippers and tourists were inside at the time, over thirty of whom were killed in the attack. This was the first fidayeen attack Lashkar executed beyond Indian-administered Kashmir since its inaugural raid on the Red Fort. The Akshardham assault was intended to avenge the pogroms that took place in Gujarat, though at roughly this time the group was also beginning to increase its focus on economic targets in order to slow India's burgeoning economy by hitting the country where it hurt financially. The story of Sabauddin Ahmed and his involvement in a Lashkar assault on the Indian Institute of Science [IISc] in Bangalore is worth briefly exploring because of what it demonstrates about the group's target selection, the role of its regional networks and the continued support provided by the ISI.

Ahmed, who was arrested in 2008 and described to investigators his experiences with Lashkar, was among those who flocked to the group after the Gujarat riots in 2002.[113] That year, one of his fellow students at university convinced him of the need to 'fight against the injustice meted